

Game birds

Game birds live most of their lives on the ground. Most are plump with a small head, short wings, and sturdy, strong legs.

Sport

Game birds, such as this male common pheasant, are hunted by humans for sport, which is why they are called game birds.

Some game birds, like these chickens, are raised specifically to provide food for humans.

Hen



Cockerel



Good-looking males

Like most male game birds, this cockerel is more brightly coloured than the hen. He uses his fine feathers to attract females.

This male common pheasant has a tough, hooked beak for digging up plant roots and insects to eat.

Males have brightly coloured feathers...

The tail drags along the ground behind the male when not spread out.



Nesting

Most game birds nest in shallow holes in the ground. They can produce more than 20 eggs in one nest – more than most other birds. Females are duller in colour than the males, to camouflage them against the ground when nesting.

Some game birds keep their eggs warm not by sitting on them, but by burying them underground.

